



Inspection Report

City of Jackson Department and Parks and Recreation
633 North State Street
Jackson, MS 39205

Customer ID: **508375**

Certificate: **65-C-0570**

Site: 001

City of Jackson Department and
Parks and Recreation

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 25-AUG-2026

3.150(a)

Facilities, general.

The facility is failing to maintain their veterinary hospital that houses the Black Vulture in good repair. At the time of the inspection, the APHIS official observed approximately three inches of standing water in the hospital hallway and offices. The building smelled strongly of mold. The ceiling of the hallway and office had wet insulation hanging down and exposed rotten wood. The ceiling area in front of the sheltered housing for the Black Vulture enclosure was patched with plywood and smelled of mold. The roof has a hole that is approximately two feet in diameter. The roofing tiles are missing in some areas with the gutters pulling away from the roof. The treatment room smells of mold with black fuzzy organic material visible in the corner near the scale.

The facility stated they haven't been able to receive enough roofing bids to move forward with repairs. The roof has been in disrepair for over three months. Housing facilities for birds must be designed and constructed so that they are structurally sound for the species of bird housed in them. They must be kept in good repair and protect the birds from injury.

Correct by: September 30, 2026

2.40(b)(1)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility does not have appropriate facilities to comply with the Animal Welfare Regulations. The veterinary hospital is in disrepair. At the time of the inspection, there were three inches of standing water inside the building. The ceiling above the hallway is deteriorated with exposed wet wood beams and insulation is hanging down. The APHIS official could smell a strong mold odor. The hospital office ceiling is also deteriorated with exposed wet beams and insulation hanging down. The hallway in front of the animal enclosures is missing ceiling tiles. The missing tiles have created a hole which is approximately three feet by two feet exposing the wood beams and insulation.

The hospital treatment room, which also has standing water and a moldy odor, is used to store the facility's medications. The controlled drug lockbox on the floor is flooded and unable to be used. There are rodent feces and nesting materials on top of the electrical box. The ceiling is discolored with fuzzy black organic material. The floor behind the metal exam table is discolored with fuzzy black organic material. There are rodent feces in the corner of the room behind the

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treatment equipment. The APHIS official could smell a strong mold odor throughout the hospital.

The roof of the building has a hole that is approximately two feet in diameter. The roofing tiles are missing in some areas with the gutters pulling away from the roof. The facility stated they haven't been able to receive enough roofing bids to move forward with repairs.

The licensee must establish and maintain a program of adequate veterinary care that includes the availability of appropriate facilities, personnel, equipment, and services to comply with the provisions of the Animal Welfare Regulations.

Correct by: October 30, 2026

2.40(b)(2)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility is maintaining expired Ciprofloxacin, Meloxicam, Sucralfate, Epinephrine, Dexamethasone, and Noromectin in their pharmacy available for use for regulated animals. The use of expired medications is not consistent with standard veterinary care and is inappropriate to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries since the expected results cannot be guaranteed. The licensee must establish and maintain a program of adequate veterinary care that includes the use of appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries.

Correct by: September 5, 2026

3.31(c)

Sanitation.

The facility has substantial evidence of pests.

In the animal diet preparation area and bedding storage building, the floor behind the bedding has a heavy accumulation of rodent feces. There are rodent feces and urine on bags of unopened feed. The building also has an accumulation of cobwebs behind feed storage and on the ceiling. This building stores food and bedding for all animals.

While the facility has instituted the use of rodent traps, it isn't an effective method of pest control. The presence of insects and mammal pests may create a disease hazard to the animals. A safe and effective program for the control of insects, ectoparasites, and avian and mammalian pests shall be established and maintained.

Correct by: September 30, 2026

3.75(c)(1)

Housing facilities, general.

The facility is not maintaining the surfaces of housing facilities including perches in the Chimpanzee, Schmidts Guenon, and Spider Monkey enclosures. The Chimpanzee perches have excessively rusted, bent bars supporting the wood planks. One perch is bent and bowing from the weight of the animal from 90 degrees to approximately 45 degrees. At least three of the perches have broken wood planks and one of the planks is no longer connected to the rusted support bar putting the animals at risk for injury. The paint has peeled from the concrete door frame of the shift gate in the individually housed Schmidts Guenon enclosure. The concrete surface is crumbling and is unable to be properly cleaned

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and sanitized.

The Spider Monkey feed perch is made of wire. The wire sides have disconnected from the wire base causing a three-inch gap. The gap puts the two spider monkeys at risk of animal entrapment.

The facility is not maintaining the shift doors for both the Chimpanzees and the Spider Monkeys; the doors are not free of excessive rust. The outer areas of the metal shift doors are reddish brown and have a pockmarked appearance. The metal bars attached to the cement wall that allow the door to shift open and closed are also a deep reddish brown with pockmarked areas. The non-human primates can come into contact with the rusted surfaces. Rusted primary enclosure surfaces can lose structural integrity over time and cannot be properly cleaned and sanitized.

The licensee must ensure that any surfaces that come into contact with non-human primates are free of excessive rust that prevents the required cleaning and sanitization, or that affects the structural strength of the surfaces.
Correct by: September 30, 2026

3.75(f)

Housing facilities, general.

At the time of the inspection, the inspector identified a backed-up drainage pipe in the Ruffed-Coat Lemur building. The facility manager stated the drainage system in this building is clogged and is not functioning.

Improper drainage systems and standing water where the animals are contained may result in noxious odors, spreading of diseases, insect infestation, and/or other health hazards. Housing facilities for non-human primates must be constructed and maintained minimizing vermin and pest infestation, insects, odors, and disease hazards.
Correct by: October 31, 2026

3.76(c)

Indoor housing facilities.

At the time of the inspection, the facility failed to maintain adequate lighting in the indoor housing facility for the Schmidt's Guenon. The light in front of the enclosure wasn't functioning properly, and the APHIS official had to utilize their flashlight to conduct the inspection because the enclosure was too dark to adequately assess the animal or the enclosure. As a result of the broken light, the guenon does not have a diurnal light cycle that is uniformly diffused throughout the animal facilities. Adequate lighting is essential to ensure thorough cleaning, proper facility maintenance, and effective daily monitoring of the primates. Indoor housing facilities must provide adequate lighting to permit routine inspection, cleaning of the facility, and observation of the nonhuman primates. Animal areas must be provided with a regular diurnal lighting cycle of either natural or artificial light. Lighting must be uniformly diffused throughout animal facilities and provide sufficient illumination to aid in maintaining good housekeeping practices, adequate cleaning, adequate inspection of animals, and for the well-being of the animals.
Correct by: September 15, 2026

3.77(c)

Sheltered housing facilities.

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The facility failed to maintain adequate lighting in the sheltered portion of the housing facility for the single housed Diana Guenon and two spider Monkeys. The light in front of the enclosure wasn't functioning, and the APHIS official had to utilize their flashlight to conduct the inspection. The guenon and spider monkeys are not provided with a diurnal light cycle that is uniformly diffused throughout the animal facilities. Adequate lighting is essential to ensure thorough cleaning, proper facility maintenance, and effective daily monitoring of the primates. The sheltered part of sheltered housing must be lighted enough to permit routine inspection, cleaning of the facility, and observation of the nonhuman primates. Animal areas must be provided with a regular diurnal lighting cycle of either natural or artificial light. Lighting must be uniformly diffused throughout animal facilities and provide sufficient illumination to aid in maintaining good housekeeping practices, adequate cleaning, adequate inspection of animals, and for the well-being of the animals.

Correct by: September 15, 2026

3.84(c)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility failed to maintain adequate housekeeping for the premises and surrounding grounds. Almost all the enclosures on the property are surrounded by tall weeds, grass, and overgrown bushes. Many of the weeds and grasses have grown to more than 10 feet in height around the enclosure housing a Colobus monkey. There are trees growing over the Chimpanzee moat towards the island. The enclosure fences of the Colobus monkey cannot be visualized due to the heavy plant overgrowth.

Tall weeds and grass provide nesting grounds and harborage for pests and vermin which can be harmful to the health and well-being of the animals housed at the facility. They also hinder the ability to inspect enclosures for disrepair.

Premises, including the surrounding grounds, must be kept clean in order to facilitate husbandry practices and to reduce or eliminate breeding and living areas for rodents, pests, and vermin. Weeds, grass, and bushes must be controlled to facilitate cleaning of the premises and pest control.

Correct by: September 30, 2026

3.84(d)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

At the time of the inspection, an APHIS official observed four dead cockroaches hanging from the light fixture in front of the Diana Guenon enclosure. There was also a live cockroach in front of this enclosure.

Pests such as cockroaches and insects can introduce pathogens, parasites, and environmental contaminants that pose direct health risks to animals. Contaminated feed or water can also diminish animal welfare, reduce nutritional quality, and create stressful or unsafe living conditions.

The facility must develop an effective program for control of insects, external parasites, and birds and mammals that are pests must be established and maintained so as to promote the health and well-being of the animals and reduce contamination by pests in animal areas.

Correct by: September 30, 2026

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3.125(a)

Facilities, general.

The housing facilities are in disrepair in several areas.

At the time of the inspection, the APHIS official smelled an electrical burning odor in the Pygmy Hippopotamus building. Upon further investigation by facility personnel, the odor was caused by a broken air conditioner. The facility must maintain the air conditioner in good repair to prevent an electrical fire and injury or death to the animals.

Other areas of the Pygmy Hippopotamus enclosure are in disrepair. The metal framed doors have wood planking that is severely deteriorated. The wood is splintered and has a hole approximately one foot by three feet in the center of the door. Failure to have doors in good repair may result in entrapment, escape, or injury to the hippos.

The fence in the Pygmy Hippopotamus enclosure is also in disrepair. A tree fell on the fence dividing the outdoor area, and the fence is currently half standing. Broken fencing can cause harm to animals.

The outdoor enclosure for 11 prairie dogs has broken wires creating sharp points. Sharp points can cause injury to the prairie dogs.

Insulation was falling out of the ceiling in the Asian Bear building. The insulation was landing in front of the enclosure near the fan that blows into the enclosure. Ingestion of insulation can cause injury to the bear.

The facility failed to maintain housing facilities for the beaver. The ceiling area in front of the sheltered housing for a Beaver enclosure is partially patched with plywood and smelled of mold. The roof has a hole that's approximately two feet in diameter. The roofing tiles are missing in some areas with the gutters pulling away from the roof.

The facility stated they haven't been able to receive enough roofing bids to move forward with repairs. The roof has been in disrepair for over three months.

The facility shall maintain the housing facilities in good repair to protect the animals from escape and injury to ensure the welfare of the animals.

Correct by: September 30, 2026

3.129(a)

Feeding.

At the time of the inspection, the APHIS official observed a box of romaine lettuce with black and white slimy mold present on the leaves. The facility is feeding this lettuce to most of the animals. There was also an opened tube of raw meat ("Nebraska Canine Diet") that was dark to medium brown in color with black crusty meat on the edges of the bag, indicating it was spoiled. The facility is feeding this meat to the otter. Feeding deteriorating food to the animals can negatively impact their health and well-being by causing foodborne illnesses. The food shall be wholesome, palatable, and free from contamination and of sufficient quantity and nutritive value to maintain all animals in good health.

Correct by: August 30, 2026

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3.131(b)

Sanitation.

The facility is failing to properly sanitize the Pygmy Hippopotamus indoor housing facilities. There is a buildup of brown organic material approximately three feet up the walls. The facility stated they are sanitizing the enclosure weekly, but the surfaces are not being cleaned often enough to prevent the buildup and debris.

The accumulation of brown organic material on all of the surfaces the regulated animals come in contact with can be a source of bacteria and possible health issues for the animals.

Cages, rooms, and hard-surfaced pens or runs shall be sanitized either by washing them with hot water (180 F. at source) and soap or detergent, as in a mechanical washer, or by washing all soiled surfaces with a detergent solution followed by a safe and effective disinfectant, or by cleaning all soiled surfaces with saturated live steam under pressure. Pens or runs using gravel, sand, or dirt, shall be sanitized when necessary, as directed by the attending veterinarian.

Correct by: September 15, 2025

3.131(d)

Sanitation.

The facility has substantial evidence of pests.

In the animal diet preparation area and bedding storage building, the floor behind the bedding has a heavy accumulation of rodent feces. There are rodent feces and urine on bags of unopened feed. The building also has an accumulation of cobwebs behind feed storage and on the ceiling. This building stores food and bedding for all animals.

In the pygmy hippo building, the inspector observed one live cockroach above the enclosure next the pygmy hippos and multiple dead cockroaches hanging from light fixtures.

While the facility has instituted the use of rodent traps, it isn't an effective method of pest control. The presence of insects and mammal pests may create a disease hazard to the animals. A safe and effective program for the control of insects, ectoparasites, and avian and mammalian pests shall be established and maintained.

Correct by: September 30, 2026

3.132

Employees.

During the inspection, the facility manager stated that he does not have sufficient help to facilitate adequate animal care, husbandry, cleaning, and maintenance of the facility. This is evident in numerous areas of the facility, as noted by the areas of disrepair and ineffective pest control throughout the facility documented in this report. There are currently nine employees to carry out all aspects of animal care for 85 animals.

Without adequate employees, animals and facilities cannot be properly managed, leading to circumstances that compromise the health and well-being of the animals. A sufficient number of adequately trained employees shall be utilized to maintain the professionally acceptable level of husbandry practices as set forth in the regulations.

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3.158(d)

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility has substantial evidence of pests.

In the animal diet preparation area and bedding storage building, the floor behind the bedding has a heavy accumulation of rodent feces. There are rodent feces and urine found on bags of unopened feed. The building also has an accumulation of cobwebs behind feed storage and on the ceiling. This building stores food and bedding for all animals. In the building containing the Nene Geese, there are diet preparation containers with rodent feces and urine present in them.

While the facility has instituted the use of rodent traps, it isn't an effective method of pest control. The presence of insects and mammal pests may create a disease hazard to the animals. A safe and effective program for the control of insects, ectoparasites, and avian and mammalian pests shall be established and maintained.

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This inspection and exit interview were conducted with a facility representative.

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
508375	65-C-0570	001	City of Jackson Department and Parks and Recreation	25-AUG-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000003	<i>Varecia rubra</i>	RED RUFFED LEMUR
000002	<i>Hylobates lar</i>	LAR GIBBON
000001	<i>Colobus guereza</i>	EASTERN BLACK-AND-WHITE COLOBUS / GUEREZA
000001	<i>Cercopithecus ascanius</i>	RED-TAILED MONKEY
000001	<i>Cercopithecus diana</i>	DIANA MONKEY
000004	<i>Pan troglodytes</i>	CHIMPANZEE
000011	<i>Cynomys ludovicianus</i>	BLACK-TAILED PRAIRIE DOG
000002	<i>Castor canadensis</i>	AMERICAN BEAVER
000001	<i>Chinchilla lanigera</i>	CHINCHILLA
000001	<i>Ursus americanus</i>	NORTH AMERICAN BLACK BEAR
000002	<i>Puma concolor</i>	PUMA / MOUNTAIN LION / COUGAR
000001	<i>Panthera tigris</i>	TIGER
000001	<i>Lontra canadensis</i>	NORTH AMERICAN RIVER OTTER
000001	<i>Potos flavus</i>	KINKAJOU
000005	<i>Potamochoerus porcus</i>	RED RIVER HOG
000001	<i>Ceratotherium simum</i>	WHITE RHINOCEROS
000001	<i>Ursus thibetanus</i>	ASIATIC BLACK BEAR
000001	<i>Equus grevyi</i>	GREVY'S ZEBRA
000002	<i>Hexaprotodon liberiensis</i>	PYGMY HIPPOPOTAMUS
000002	<i>Struthio camelus</i>	COMMON OSTRICH
000002	<i>Bugeranus carunculatus</i>	WATTLED CRANE
000003	<i>Dacelo novaeguineae</i>	LAUGHING KOOKABURRA
000001	<i>Antigone vipio</i>	WHITE-NAPED CRANE
000001	<i>Bubo virginianus</i>	GREAT HORNED OWL
000001	<i>Ara chloropterus</i>	RED-AND-GREEN MACAW / GREEN-WINGED MACAW
000001	<i>Coragyps atratus</i>	BLACK VULTURE / MEXICAN VULTURE
000001	<i>Ducula bicolor</i>	PIED IMPERIAL-PIGEON
000001	<i>Cacatua tenuirostris</i>	LONG-BILLED CORELLA
000001	<i>Ara ararauna</i>	BLUE-AND-YELLOW MACAW / BLUE-AND-GOLD MACAW
000003	<i>Cygnus melancoryphus</i>	BLACK-NECKED SWAN
000012	<i>Phoenicopiterus ruber</i>	AMERICAN FLAMINGO
000002	<i>Branta sandvicensis</i>	HAWAIIAN GOOSE / NE-NE
000002	<i>Cacatua alba</i>	WHITE COCKATOO / UMBRELLA COCKATOO
000002	<i>Chauna torquata</i>	SOUTHERN SCREAMER / CRESTED SCREAMER
000002	<i>Ateles fusciceps</i>	BROWN-HEADED SPIDER MONKEY
000002	<i>Mustela putorius</i>	EUROPEAN POLECAT
000004	<i>Cavia porcellus</i>	DOMESTIC GUINEA PIG
000085	Total	



United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

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